



TaskFlow

Complete User Manual

Task Management · Real-Time Collaboration · Role-Based Access

Version 2.0 | 2026

Dashboard

Kanban

Analytics

Roadmap

Search

Table of Contents

1. Getting Started	3
System Requirements	3
Launching the App	3
Login & Demo Accounts	3
2. Dashboard	4
3. My Tasks	5
Board View (Kanban)	5
List View	5
Table View	5
Creating & Editing Tasks	6
4. All Projects	7
Creating a Project	7
Project Detail Page	7
5. Today Page	8
6. Search	9
7. Workload	10
8. Activity Feed	11
9. Time Tracking	11
10. Roadmap	12
11. Analytics	13
12. Calendar	14
13. Settings	15
14. Real-Time Collaboration	16
15. Role-Based Permissions	17
16. Keyboard Shortcuts	18
17. Security & Authentication	19

1. Getting Started

System Requirements

- Modern web browser: Chrome 110+, Firefox 115+, Edge 110+, or Safari 16+
- Node.js 18+ (for running the development server locally)
- Internet connection not required — runs fully locally
- Screen resolution: 1024×768 minimum (1280×900 recommended)

Launching the App

Open a terminal in the project root and run both servers:

Backend server (authentication + real-time):

```
cd server && npx tsx src/index.ts
```

Frontend development server:

```
npx vite --port 5175
```

Open your browser and navigate to: <http://localhost:5175>

Login & Demo Accounts

Three built-in demo accounts cover every permission level. Use the **Fill demo credentials** buttons on the login page for one-click access.

Role	Email	Password	Access Level
Admin	alex@taskflow.io	Admin1234!	Full — create, edit, delete everything
Member	sarah@taskflow.io	Member1234!	Create & edit tasks and projects
Viewer	marcus@taskflow.io	Viewer1234!	Read-only — view only

Passwords are validated server-side. After 5 failed attempts the account is locked for 60 seconds (brute-force protection).

2. Dashboard

The Dashboard is your command centre — it loads automatically after login and gives an instant overview of team activity and your personal workload.

Stat Cards (top row)

- **Total Tasks** — all tasks across every project in the workspace
- **In Progress** — tasks currently assigned to active work
- **Completed** — tasks marked Done
- **Overdue** — tasks whose due date has passed and are not yet Done

Charts

- **Tasks This Week** — bar chart showing daily task completions for the current week
- **By Status** — doughnut chart breaking down tasks by status across the workspace

My Active Tasks

A personalised list of tasks assigned to you that are not yet Done. Click any row to open the full Task Detail panel.

Projects Overview

Cards for each active project showing name, progress bar (% tasks Done), member count, and total task count. Click a card to go directly to that project.

Quick Tip

Press Cmd/Ctrl + K at any time to open the Command Palette and jump to any page instantly.

Click the notification bell (top-right) to see overdue and due-today task alerts.

3. My Tasks

My Tasks shows every task assigned to you across all projects. Switch between three views using the toggle buttons in the top-right of the page.

Board View (Kanban)

Tasks are arranged in columns by status. Drag a card from one column to another to update its status instantly. Columns available:

- To Do
- In Progress
- In Review
- Done
- Blocked

List View

A compact vertical list grouped by project. Each row shows priority badge, status badge, assignee avatar, due date, and tag chips. Supports inline status change by clicking the status badge.

Table View

A spreadsheet-style view with sortable columns: Title, Status, Priority, Project, Assignee, Due Date, Tags, and Logged Hours. Click any column header to sort. Click a row to open Task Detail.

Filtering & Searching

- Use the **search bar** to filter tasks by title keyword in real time
- The **status filter** pills (All / To Do / In Progress / Done / Blocked) narrow results instantly
- The **priority filter** dropdown filters by Critical / High / Medium / Low
- Click **Filters** to expand advanced filters: assignee, due date range, sprint, tags

Creating a New Task

- Click the **New Task** button in the header, or press **N** anywhere in the app
- Fill in: Title (required), Description (Markdown supported), Status, Priority
- Optionally assign to a team member, set a due date, attach tags, or link to a sprint
- Click **Create Task** — the task is saved and broadcast to all connected users

Editing a Task

- Click any task card or row to open the **Task Detail panel** (slides in from the right)
- Edit any field inline — changes auto-save and sync in real time
- Use the **Log Time** button to record hours worked
- Add **comments** (supports @mentions and Markdown)
- Start a **Focus Mode** or **Pomodoro timer** from within the detail panel
- Admins and Members can delete a task using the trash icon in the panel header

Task Priority Levels

Critical — must be resolved immediately

High — important, address soon

Medium — normal priority

Low — can be deferred

4. All Projects

The All Projects page lists every project in the workspace. Use the filter tabs to switch between Active, Completed, and All.

Creating a Project

- Click **New Project** (Admin or Member role required)
- Enter a project name, optional description, and select a colour
- Click **Create Project** — the project is available immediately to all users

Project Cards

Each card displays: project name and colour, task counts, team member avatars, progress bar (Done / total), and creation date. Click a card to enter the Project Detail page.

Project Detail Page

Inside a project you will find:

- **Stats Grid** — Total tasks, Done, In Progress, Overdue counts
- **Task Board** — full Kanban board scoped to this project; drag-and-drop supported
- **Add Task** — creates a task pre-assigned to this project
- **Back to All Projects** — breadcrumb navigation at the top
- **Sprint Management** — create and manage sprints within the project

5. Today Page

The Today page is your personalised daily planning view. Navigate to it via the sidebar or press the keyboard shortcut.

Greeting & Date Header

Displays a context-aware greeting (Good morning / afternoon / evening) with your first name, the current date, and a summary line (e.g. "3 tasks due today").

Today's Focus

- Pin up to **3 tasks** as your focus for the day by clicking the star icon on any task
- Focused tasks appear at the top with a progress bar showing how many are Done
- Click a focused task to open its full detail panel
- Use the + button to add more candidates from your active tasks

Task Sections

- **Due Today** — tasks whose due date is today and are not yet Done
- **Overdue** — tasks past their due date; shown with a red indicator
- **In Progress** — tasks you have started but not yet completed
- **Blocked** — tasks with Blocked status assigned to you
- **Completed Yesterday** — tasks you finished yesterday for context

Standup Report

Expand the **Standup Report** section to generate a ready-to-paste daily standup in Markdown format, including:

- Done Yesterday — tasks you completed
- Today — tasks due or in progress
- Blockers — any tasks with Blocked status
- Click **Copy to Clipboard** to paste directly into Slack or your standup tool

6. Search

The Search page provides full-text search across all workspace content. Open it via the sidebar, or press **Cmd/Ctrl + K** to use the Command Palette quick-search from anywhere in the app.

What Is Searched

- Task titles and descriptions
- Task comments
- Project names and descriptions

Scope Filter Pills

Narrow results to a specific content type using the pills below the search bar:

- **Everything** — searches all content types simultaneously
- **Tasks** — returns only matching tasks
- **Projects** — returns only matching projects

Advanced Filters (Tasks)

- Expand the **Filters** panel to filter results by status, priority, assignee, or due date
- Matched keywords are highlighted in yellow within results
- Press **Escape** to clear the search field instantly

Result Cards

Each result shows: highlighted title, description excerpt, status badge, priority badge, assignee avatar, project name, and relative due date. Click any result to open its detail panel.

7. Workload

The Workload page gives team leads and admins a visual overview of how work is distributed across the team.

Summary Metric Cards

- **Total Active Tasks** — all non-Done tasks across the workspace
- **Overloaded Members** — members with more than 5 active tasks
- **Average Load** — average active task count per team member
- **Capacity Used** — workspace-level capacity utilisation percentage

Per-Member Cards

Each team member has an individual card showing:

- Avatar, name, and role badge
- Active task count with a colour-coded load bar
- Load level badge: **Light** / **Moderate** / **Heavy** / **Overloaded**
- Breakdown of tasks by status (To Do, In Progress, Blocked)
- Click **View Tasks** to jump to a filtered view of that member's tasks

8. Activity Feed

The Activity Feed is an audit trail of everything that happens in the workspace — useful for tracking changes, catching up after absence, and accountability.

Event Types

- **created** — a new task or project was created
- **updated** — a task field was changed (status, priority, assignee, etc.)
- **commented** — a comment was added to a task
- **assigned** — a task was assigned to a team member
- **deleted** — a task or project was removed
- **completed** — a task was marked as Done

Filtering

Use the **verb filter pills** at the top to show only specific event types. Events are sorted newest-first. Each entry shows: actor avatar, action description, timestamp, and a link to the affected item.

9. Time Tracking

Time Tracking gives you a summary of hours logged across your tasks for any time period. Hours are logged from within the Task Detail panel.

How to Log Time

- Open a task via the detail panel
- Click **Log Time** and enter hours manually, OR
- Use the **Timer** button in the header — starts a live stopwatch tied to the task
- Click **Stop Timer** to automatically add the elapsed time to the task
- For focused work, use **Pomodoro Mode** (25-minute countdown timer)

Time Tracking Dashboard

- **Date range filters** — Last 7 days / 30 days / 90 days / 6 months / All time
- Total hours logged in the selected range
- Per-project breakdown bar chart
- Per-task breakdown table with task name, project, and hours logged

10. Roadmap

The Roadmap page shows all projects on a horizontal timeline, making it easy to see overlaps, gaps, and long-term planning.

Timeline View

- Each project occupies a row in the sidebar; its duration bar spans start → end date
- Bars are colour-coded by project colour
- Month column headers run horizontally across the top
- Use the **Previous** / **Next** month navigation buttons to scroll the timeline
- Hover over a project bar to see name, date range, and task count tooltip

Reading the Timeline

- A bar that starts mid-column indicates the project begins partway through that month
- Overlapping bars indicate concurrent projects — useful for resource planning
- Projects without a set end date appear as open-ended bars

11. Analytics

The Analytics page provides deep quantitative insight into workspace productivity using interactive charts powered by Recharts.

Date Range Filter

All charts respond to the date range selector at the top of the page:

- Last 7 days
- Last 30 days
- Last 90 days
- Last 6 months
- All time

Metric Cards

- **Total Tasks** — workspace task count in the selected range
- **Overdue** — count of tasks past due date and not Done
- **Completion Rate** — percentage of tasks that are Done
- **Completed** — absolute count of Done tasks
- **Avg Velocity** — average tasks completed per week over the last 8 weeks

Charts Available

Chart	Type	What it shows
Completed Per Week	Bar chart	Tasks finished per calendar week (last 8 weeks)
Status Distribution	Pie chart	Proportion of tasks in each status
Priority Breakdown	Pie chart	Task split by Critical / High / Medium / Low
Completion Trend	Line chart	Cumulative completed tasks over the selected range
Team Productivity	Grouped bar	Assigned vs completed vs in-progress per team member
Project Breakdown	Bar chart	Total tasks created per project
Tag Usage	Bar chart	Most-used tags across all tasks
Due Date Adherence	Pie chart	On-time vs late task completions
Sprint Velocity	Line chart	Velocity (story points) across completed sprints

12. Calendar

The Calendar page displays all tasks with due dates on a monthly grid, giving a visual schedule of upcoming deadlines.

Navigation

- Use the **Previous** / **Next** arrow buttons to move between months
- Click **Today** to return to the current month instantly
- The current day is highlighted with a blue ring

Calendar Grid

- Each cell represents a day; task chips appear on their due dates
- Task chips are colour-coded by **priority**: red = Critical, orange = High, blue = Medium, grey = Low
- Click a task chip to open its full Task Detail panel
- Days with overdue tasks are shown with a red badge count in the top-right corner of the cell

Adding Tasks from Calendar

Click any day cell to open the New Task modal with that date pre-filled as the due date — useful for scheduling tasks directly from the calendar.

13. Settings

The Settings page lets you personalise your profile, appearance, team, and data preferences.

Profile Section

- Displays your current name, email address, and role badge
- Shows your assigned colour (used for avatars throughout the app)

Appearance

- **Dark Mode** (default) — deep navy colour scheme optimised for long work sessions
- **Light Mode** — switches the entire app to a bright white theme
- Toggle is saved to localStorage and persists across sessions

Notifications

- Enable / disable browser push notifications for task due dates and assignments
- Click **Enable Notifications** to grant browser permission
- Once enabled, TaskFlow sends alerts for overdue tasks and tasks due today

Team Members

View all workspace members with their name, email, role, and avatar colour. The **You** badge highlights your own account.

Data Management

- **Export Data** — downloads a JSON backup of all tasks, projects, tags, and sprints
- **Clear All Data** — resets the workspace to a blank state (Admin only — irreversible)

14. Real-Time Collaboration

TaskFlow includes a Socket.io-powered collaboration layer. Multiple users can work simultaneously and see each other's changes live.

Presence Bar

When multiple users are online, their avatars appear in the **Presence Bar** at the top of the header. Hover an avatar to see the user's name and role.

Connection Status Indicator

A small dot in the header shows your connection state:

- **Green** — connected and synced
- **Yellow** — connecting or reconnecting
- **Red** — disconnected (changes will not sync until reconnected)

Live Sync Events

These actions are broadcast instantly to all connected users:

- Task created, updated, or deleted
- Task status changed (including drag-and-drop on Kanban)
- Comment added to a task
- Project created or updated

Snapshot Sync

When you first connect (or reconnect after a network interruption), the server sends a full snapshot of all current tasks and projects, ensuring your view is always up to date without a page refresh.

Collaboration Note

Real-time features require the backend server (port 3002) to be running.

If the Connection Status shows red, restart the server with: `cd server && npx tsx src/index.ts`

15. Role-Based Permissions

TaskFlow enforces three permission levels. Roles are set server-side and cannot be changed by the client.

Action	Admin	Member	Viewer
View tasks & projects	Yes	Yes	Yes
Create tasks	Yes	Yes	No
Edit own tasks	Yes	Yes	No
Edit any task	Yes	No	No
Delete any task	Yes	No	No
Create projects	Yes	Yes	No
Edit / delete projects	Yes	No	No
Add comments	Yes	Yes	No
Export workspace data	Yes	Yes	No
Clear all data	Yes	No	No
Real-time broadcast (mutate)	Yes	Yes	No

16. Keyboard Shortcuts

TaskFlow is designed for power users. Press **?** anywhere in the app (when not in a text field) to open the Shortcuts Modal.

Shortcut	Action
N	Open New Task modal
P	Open New Project modal
Cmd/Ctrl + K	Open Command Palette
?	Open Keyboard Shortcuts reference modal
Escape	Close any open modal, panel, or palette
Cmd/Ctrl + Enter	Submit / save the currently open form
/	Focus the header search input
G then D	Go to Dashboard
G then T	Go to Today page
G then M	Go to My Tasks
G then P	Go to All Projects
G then A	Go to Analytics
G then S	Go to Settings

Command Palette

Press Cmd/Ctrl + K to open the Command Palette — a fuzzy-search launcher.

Type any page name, action, or task title to jump instantly.

Results include: navigation links, quick-create actions, and recent tasks.

17. Security & Authentication

TaskFlow uses a layered security architecture suitable for team environments. All security controls are enforced server-side.

Token-Based Authentication

- On login, the server validates credentials and issues an **HMAC-SHA256 signed token**
- Tokens expire after **8 hours** — you will be prompted to log in again
- The token is stored in **localStorage** and sent with every WebSocket connection
- The server verifies the token cryptographically before accepting any connection
- Passwords are **never** stored in the client bundle or transmitted in plain text

Brute-Force Protection

- After **5 failed login attempts**, the account is locked for 60 seconds
- The lockout is per-email and resets on a successful login
- Server-side rate limiting is applied independently of the client-side guard

WebSocket Security

- Every Socket.io connection is authenticated via token in the handshake
- Unauthenticated connections are rejected before any data is exchanged
- User identity is extracted from the verified token — clients cannot spoof roles
- All mutating socket events are validated and audit-logged server-side

Content Security Policy

- Production builds enforce a strict CSP — **inline scripts are blocked**
- Development mode allows unsafe-inline for HMR (hot module replacement) only
- XSS protection: all user-supplied strings are HTML-entity-encoded before rendering

Best Practices for Admins

- Change the default **TOKEN_SECRET** in `server/src/index.ts` before production deployment
- Use HTTPS in production — tokens are sensitive and must not travel over plain HTTP
- Run **Export Data** regularly from Settings as a backup
- Only grant Admin role to trusted team members — Admin can delete all data

Quick Reference — Common Tasks

I want to...	Go to...	Shortcut
Create a new task	Anywhere	N
See my work for today	Today page	G T
Find a specific task	Search page	Cmd+K

I want to...	Go to...	Shortcut
Check team capacity	Workload page	—
See what changed	Activity Feed	—
View project timeline	Roadmap page	—
Analyse productivity	Analytics page	G A
Log time on a task	Task Detail panel	—
Export workspace data	Settings page	—
Open any page quickly	Command Palette	Cmd+K

For support or feedback, visit the project repository on GitHub: github.com/paulcoletd/TaskFlow